EVERCORE ISI

Technology | Internet

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Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN | $238.38

Outperform | Target Price/Base Case: $285.00

Commentary

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Company Statistics

Market Capitalization (B)	$2,421
52-Week Range	$161.38 - $258.60

Earnings Summary

		2025	2026E
Revenue (B)	Q1	$156	$178
	Q2	$168	$192
	Q3	$180	$206
	Q4	$213	$242
	FY	**$717**	**$818**
EBITDA (B)	Q1	$37	$46
	Q2	$41	$52
	Q3	$42	$54
	Q4	$50	$65
	FY	**$170**	**$218**
EPS	Q1	$1.59	$1.63
	Q2	$1.68	$1.68
	Q3	$1.95	$1.78
	Q4	$1.95	$2.50
	FY	**$7.17**	**$7.60**

1 Year Price History

Source: FactSet

The Mythos Rally And Our "30 for 30" Thesis

Our View: Following up from our recent AWS Deep Dive report (link here) and our takeaways from the Annual Amazon CEO Shareholder Letter (link here), we are reiterating our Outperform call on AMZN – our #1 'Net Long recommendation – and our $285 PT. We are now riffing off an outstanding thought piece published by our colleague Kevin Rippey, Evercore's TMT Sector Specialist, over the weekend re: whether Anthropic's ground-breaking Mythos Model was trained (at least in part) on Trainium 2. To the extent that it was – and Rippey's logic and datapoints strongly suggest that it was – it's a powerful "proof of product" for Amazon's Trainium offering.

There's a clear stock so-what here. In a way that is markedly similar to the narrative u-turn on GOOGL last Spring/Summer, we may well be at the beginning of a massive narrative shift on AMZN. Over the last three years, AMZN has been a dramatic de-rater – from approx. 40X P/E to as low as 20X P/E – based largely on two concerns. First, the concern that AWS was a constant Cloud market share donor. And second, the concern that AWS had "missed" the Gen AI transition. Over the last two quarters, AWS has actually grown Cloud revenue dollars faster than its competitors – a development that begins to address the first concern. Per our recent AWS Deep Dive report, we believe that AWS is on target for a "30 for 30" outcome in 2027 – 30%+ revenue growth and 30%+ operating margins. If we are right, this will fully address the first concern.

This Mythos Model connection to Trainium is key in that it helps address the second concern. If Trainium 2 is powerful enough to help train Mythos, then Amazon's Trainium offering may be much more robust than the market realized, in addition to having 30-40% better price-performance than GPU-based instances.

Here's the key section from Rippey's note: *"Up until a week ago (and arguably for most investors even now), [there is the belief that] there is effectively 1 credible ASIC in the market (TPU), and Trainium while showing progress, isn't quite in the same game; we'd need to wait to see a big Trainium3 cluster before AWS had a real shot at competing with the output we're seeing from NVDA or GOOG. This narrative gets upended if you share the view that a 10T parameter model like Mythos was a Trainium2 product. Of course, we knew (or at least didn't debate much) that Opus was trained on Trainium, but I'd contend that investors were not prepared for something like Mythos to be possible on the n-1 generation Trainium Hardware (trn2 has been out since late 2024).*

It's also a Software stack milestone, Anthropic said it's writing low-level kernels that interface directly with Trainium silicon and contributing to the Neuron stack. A successful 10T-class run is evidence that Neuron plus Anthropic/AWS co-design is mature …

enough for frontier training, the category most people still assume belongs to NVIDIA-centered tooling / or the full vertical integration of GOOG/TPU.

On the cost side, Trn2 offers 30–40% better price-performance than GPU-based P5e/P5en instances (AWS lingo for H100/200). The success of training Mythos on Trn2 means AWS can handle the pretraining and weakens the argument that frontier labs (ex-GOOG) must default to NVIDIA for every major run."

Looking at the 20% rally in AMZN shares since March 27th, the day that word of Anthropic's new Mythos model was first leaked, surely part of the market sees a re-rating catalyst/development for AMZN. As we pointed out in our Weekly piece last Friday (email Kevin for distribution), AMZN is going through a Mythos Rally.

But our stronger point is that given everything else going on with Amazon (in its AWS, Retail, Advertising and new growth areas), we may well finally be in the midst of – at the beginning of -- a major re-rating event with AMZN shares. A re-rating that doesn't need to stop at 30X P/E ($285). It could actually go to 35X ($330) or even possibly 40X ($375). Just as a check…did you really think in the Spring of 2025 that GOOGL (@ 15X P/E at the time) would ever see 20X or 25X again? And it exceeded 30X.

For the record, here's our AMZN Long Thesis: AMZN is our #1 Long recommendation for 2026, as we **a)** view current valuation as compelling (close to a 3-year trough P/E multiple); **b)** see the probability of a fundamental inflection point this year (i.e. accelerating revenue growth and operating margin expansion); **c)** see notable upside to Street estimates; and **d)** point to the significant potential for some of AMZN's newer long-term growth initiatives (esp. Project Leo & Perishable Checkout) to begin to demonstrate real traction in 2026. The $200B overhang on AMZN remains its unprecedented capex outlook, but we believe Capex Intensity (Capex as % of Revenue) is likely to peak in 2026, with FCF losses troughing in either '26 or '27 (for now, we estimate approx. $10B FCF losses in each year, even with capex ramping to $250B in 2027). There is a not-immaterial possibility that 2027 -- and not 2026 – will be the peak Capex Intensity year for AMZN and that FCF losses could rise materially in 2027. But we believe this outcome is likely in the stock at 23X P/E. Risk-reward looks compelling here. The GOOGL of 2026.

More on Mythos and our "30 for 30" Thesis: Mythos matters most because it would represent external validation of AWS's AI stack, not just an internal Amazon proof point. AWS officially launched Claude Mythos Preview on Amazon Bedrock on Apr. 7 in gated research preview. Anthropic had already said in late 2024 that AWS is its primary cloud and training partner, that Anthropic would use AWS Trainium and Inferentia for future foundation models, and that Anthropic engineers were writing low-level kernels for Trainium and contributing to the AWS Neuron software stack. Amazon has also since disclosed that Trainium2 powers Project Rainier, a 500,000+ Trainium2-chip cluster Anthropic is using to train Claude. Those datapoints do not, by themselves, formally prove that Mythos specifically was trained on Trainium2, but together they materially strengthen that read-through. Importantly, this would be as much a software-stack milestone as a silicon milestone: if Anthropic can run a frontier training pipeline on Trainium2, then Neuron maturity is likely further along than many investors appreciated.

We believe this may be more significant than Google's TPU/Gemini validation because Anthropic is a third-party frontier lab, not a vertically integrated internal customer. Google proving TPU worked for Google models was strategically important. Anthropic proving Trainium works for Anthropic models would be incrementally more powerful for investors because it speaks to portability. In our view, that makes the result more relevant for how investors should think about CUDA switching costs, AWS's ability to win additional frontier workloads, and the possibility that Trainium is not merely an internal AWS optimization tool but a credible external alternative for frontier-scale training.

If investors come to believe that Trainium is now credible for frontier pre-training, then AWS starts to look less like a company merely spending aggressively to keep up in AI, and more like a company likely to monetize a differentiated AI product stack. It may strengthen the argument that AWS has as strong a footing as GOOGL's TPU ecosystem and may challenge the view that NVIDIA remains the only credible platform for frontier pre-training. That would help narrow both major overhangs at once: 1) the AI-laggard concern; 2) the cloud-share concern. We reiterate AMZN's narrative could flip from AI laggard to AI winner, in a way somewhat analogous to GOOGL's rerating once custom silicon credibility became harder to ignore. Meanwhile, AWS's 24% Q4 revenue growth, 35% operating margin, record $244B backlog, and accelerating custom-silicon scale were already starting to prove out the AWS investment case.

This is also where the "30 for 30" thesis becomes more believable. Our AWS deep dive estimated AWS revenue growth of 27% in 2026 and 31% in 2027, with AWS operating margins of 34% and 32%, respectively, and argued that AWS could still sustain low-to-mid-30s margins even as AI mix rises. The key to that framework is that AWS does not monetize AI as bare-metal compute alone. Over time, Bedrock plus higher-value attach layers around AI workloads including storage, retrieval, orchestration, observability, networking, and security, should support better economics than pure infrastructure-as-a-service. Mythos/Trainium is not just a chip datapoint. It is a potential validation of the revenue-acceleration-plus-margin-durability combo. In that framework, Mythos / Trainium would matter because it strengthens both sides of the equation: faster growth through higher AI workload credibility and better margins through internal silicon, lower training cost, and platform attach.

We think there are three incrementally informative implications that should be made explicit. 1) If Mythos was trained on Trainium2, then AWS may have crossed the credibility threshold one generation earlier than many investors expected; the market narrative had effectively assumed investors would need to wait for Trainium3 or a still-larger future cluster before AWS could be viewed as truly frontier-capable. 2) This would weaken the argument that frontier labs must default to NVIDIA for every major run, particularly if AWS can pair Trainium with a mature Neuron stack and materially lower cost. 3) It would suggest that the switching costs the market assigns to CUDA may be overstated over the medium term. AWS says Trainium2-based Trn2 instances and UltraServers offer 30%–40% better price performance than GPU-based EC2 P5e/P5en instances, while Neuron remains the developer stack that includes the compiler, runtime, libraries, and developer tools needed to actually train and deploy on AWS silicon.

Bottom line: we think Mythos / Trainium could be the datapoint that begins to change the AMZN debate in a more material way. The cleanest bull case for the stock remains AWS revenue acceleration into 2027 with margins holding in the 30s. If Trainium is increasingly viewed as a credible, lower-cost frontier-AI alternative, then the narrative on AMZN could shift meaningfully, just as much as GOOGL's did when the market began to appreciate TPU as a real strategic asset. We think Mythos could mark a genuine proof-of-product moment for AWS. And if this interpretation is right, then what looked like capex-heavy catch-up spending may increasingly be viewed instead as the build-out of a differentiated AI platform.

Figure 1: AMZN Valuation & Price Target

($ in millions, except per share amounts)

Current Share Price	$238.38	
Diluted Shares Outstanding (MM)	10,883	
Current Market Cap	$2,594,290	
Less: Cash and Other Assets	$159,643	
Add: Debt	$65,648	
Enterprise Value	$2,500,294	
EV To EBITDA		**2027E**
EBITDA ($MM)		$268,619
EV/EBITDA on '26 EBITDA		11.5x
EV/EBITDA on '27 EBITDA		9.3x
EBITDA CAGR ('25-'28)		23%
Target Multiple		**12x**
Enterprise Value		$3,223,429
Plus: Cash		$159,643
Less: Debt		$65,648
Equity Market Capitalization		$3,317,424
	Price Target:	**$305**
P/E		**2027E**
GAAP EPS		$9.39
P/E on '26 GAAP EPS		31.4x
P/E on '27 GAAP EPS		25.4x
GAAP EPS CAGR '25-'28		17%
Target Multiple		**30x**
	Price Target:	**$282**
	Average PT (Rounded)	**$285**

Source: Company Data, Evercore ISI Research

VALUATION METHODOLOGY

We derive our price target from an EV/EBITDA methodology.

RISKS

1.) Government regulation across Amazon's business lines both in the US and abroad that either subdues profitability or limits Amazon's ability to take market share.

2.) Vertical-specific backlash aimed at AWS in an industry attempt to "not fund the competition".

3.) Large-scale data breach at AWS that diminishes customer trust and thus makes it difficult to better attack data-sensitive verticals like Financial Services and Government.

COMPANIES UNDER COVERAGE BY AUTHOR

Symbol	Company	Rating	Price (2026-13-04)	Evercore ISI Target
ABNB	Airbnb, Inc.	Outperform	$128.96	$145.00
AMZN	Amazon.com, Inc.	Outperform	$238.38	$285.00
BKNG	Booking Holdings Inc.	Outperform	$173.46	$6250.00
CHWY	Chewy, Inc.	Outperform	$25.21	
CHYM	Chime Financial, Inc.	Outperform	$19.61	$35.00
DASH	DoorDash, Inc	Outperform	$152.58	$300.00
DUOL	Duolingo, Inc.	In Line	$90.03	$114.00
EBAY	eBay Inc.	In Line	$95.40	$94.00
EXPE	Expedia Group	Outperform	$228.09	$350.00
GOOGL	Alphabet, Inc.	Outperform	$317.24	$400.00
GRAB	Grab Holdings, Inc.	Outperform	$3.68	$8.00
HIMS	Hims & Hers Health, Inc.	In Line	$19.43	$24.00
IBTA	Ibotta, Inc.	In Line	$31.89	$29.00
LIF	Life360, Inc.	Outperform	$38.10	$76.00
LYFT	Lyft, Inc	In Line	$13.23	$21.00
META	Meta Platforms Inc.	Outperform	$629.86	$900.00
MNTN	MNTN, Inc.	Outperform	$8.40	$27.00
NFLX	Netflix, Inc.	Outperform	$103.01	$115.00
ODD	Oddity Tech Ltd	In Line	$14.53	$23.00
PINS	Pinterest, Inc.	In Line	$17.62	$25.00
PTRN	Pattern Group, Inc.	Outperform	$12.44	$23.00
RDDT	Reddit, Inc.	Outperform	$139.73	$290.00
SHOP	Shopify Inc	Outperform	$110.79	$135.00
SNAP	Snap, Inc.	In Line	$4.82	$9.00
SPOT	Spotify Technology S.A	Outperform	$475.99	$650.00
STUB	StubHub Holdings, Inc.	Outperform	$6.27	$14.00
TTD	Trade Desk Inc.	Outperform	$20.09	$32.00
UBER	Uber Technologies, Inc	Outperform	$70.48	$150.00
WBTN	WEBTOON Entertainment Inc.	Outperform	$11.12	$15.00
ZG	Zillow Group Inc.	Outperform	$39.94	$80.00

TIMESTAMP

(Article 3(1)e and Article 7 of MAR)

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Ratings	**Count**	**Pct.**	**Ratings**	**Count**	**Pct.**
Buy	454	59	Buy	82	18
Hold	272	36	Hold	16	6
Sell	12	2	Sell	0	0
Coverage Suspended	9	1	Coverage Suspended	1	11
Rating Suspended	18	2	Rating Suspended	8	44

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Price Charts

Ratings Key

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H	Hold	IL	In Line	NP	No Position	RS	Rating Suspended
S	Sell	UP	Underperform	S	Short		

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